



This image is made of tiny dots of each CMYK color.

Four-color process

When printing, computers produce four layers of the same image—one for each of the four CMYK colors. Putting the four layers together, a beautiful, vivid image is created, such as this photograph of coral and fish in the Red Sea.

COLOR MIXING

Color pictures on paper are made by mixing paints or printing inks. This is called subtractive mixing. When light lands on images of a certain color, they absorb (or subtract) a specific color of that light and the other colors left are reflected back to us. The mixture of them results in the final color we see. Electronic devices, however, make color by mixing light and instead use additive mixing, where red, blue, and green light are added together to produce different colors.

